

Friday, 11 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Drizzle 22° 16°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 21° 15°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 19° 14°	GLASGOW Light drizzle 16° 13°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Bayeux Tapestry unveiled to UK public for first time at British Museum.

Visitors tell the BBC it was a "real privilege" to be among the first to see the tapestry in England.

UK · NEWS
- 2

Migraines and acne among five more conditions pharmacists can treat.

Pharmacies in England will soon offer treatments for a total of 12 common conditions which save people going to their GP first.

UK · NEWS
- 3

Ex-Tory campaign chief pleads guilty over election bet.

Anthony Lee passed confidential information to his wife Laura Lee about when the 2024 election would be held.

POLITICS · UK
- 4

Michael Sheen says he was snubbed by first minister over toxic pollution claims.

The actor urged MPs to back a national testing programme to make sure historic toxic dump sites were safe.

POLITICS · UK
- 5

Council told to disclose 24,000 pages of Sara Sharif files.

A coroner leading the inquest into the Sara's death orders Surrey County Council to hand over files.

UK · NEWS

What's coming up

- 1 Esther Rantzen says she is too fragile to travel to Switzerland to end life.**
The broadcaster and campaigner says she missed her chance to go before living with cancer became "unbearable".
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 Actor Noel Clarke charged with sexual offences.**
Clarke has been charged with offences including sexual assault. BBC News has asked him for a comment.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 Channel 4 to cut 340 jobs by the end of the year in major shake-up.**
It comes after the network conducted a review amid a "rapidly changing media landscape".
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 South Park creators rename show 'South America' in apparent dig at Trump.**
Since beginning his second term, the US president has said he wanted to use the word 'America' to rename a lake, a gulf and even a US state.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 Shane Richie pleads not guilty to drink-driving.**
The 62-year-old actor was arrested by police at a petrol station forecourt in July 2026
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 Cricket: Today at the Test.**
Day 2 highlights from the third Test match between England and Pakistan at Edgbaston.
SPORT · UK
- 2 Hamilton and Leclerc 'squash' Monza controversy.**
Lewis Hamilton says he and Ferrari team-mate Charles Leclerc have "squashed" any controversy between them from the Italian Grand Prix.
SPORT · UK
- 3 GB return after pregnancy 'hard to put into words' - Kinsella.**
A year after giving birth, Alice Kinsella takes the latest step on her groundbreaking return to gymnastics at an international meeting for Great Britain.
SPORT · UK
- 4 'Get a life' - non-league club condemn man impersonating manager.**
Gainsborough Trinity condemn a person who has been approaching players while falsely claiming to be their manager.
SPORT · UK
- 5 England march to early win over Pakistan halted by rain.**
Harry Brook, Dan Lawrence, Jamie Smith and Ollie Robinson all bat half-centuries on day two of the third Test for England, with rain the only respite for a Pakistan side trailing by 268.
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that the gentle art of 'leaf pressing' is making a delightful comeback.**
Families are rediscovering the simple joy of collecting beautiful autumn leaves and preserving them. It's a wonderful way to connect with nature and create lovely, free keepsakes.
- 2 The humble act of 'leaving anonymous positive sticky notes' in public places is spreading small smiles and cheer.**
It seems a few kind words, left on a park bench or a library book, can brighten someone's day unexpectedly. It's a lovely, low-effort way to spread a bit of positivity around.
- 3 More people are embracing the quirky hobby of 'collecting interesting pebbles' found on their local walks.**
From smooth, sea-worn stones to strikingly coloured river pebbles, these small treasures are being gathered and displayed. It's a simple pleasure that costs absolutely nothing.
- 4 A new report highlights the growing trend of 'community book swaps' appearing in front gardens and local cafes.**
These charming mini-libraries allow neighbours to share their favourite reads freely. It's a wonderful way to discover new authors and engage with your local community.
- 5 The charming tradition of 'writing handwritten letters' is seeing an unexpected resurgence amongst younger generations.**
There's something uniquely special about receiving a personal, tangible letter in the post. It offers a slower, more considered form of communication in our fast-paced world.
- 6 A fascinating survey reveals that many of us secretly 'name our house plants' and even chat to them.**
From ferns named Ferdinand to peace lilies called Penelope, giving plants a personality seems to make us more attentive to their care. It's a cute little habit we often keep to ourselves!
- 7 There's a delightful movement encouraging people to 'decorate their windows with seasonal art' to cheer up passers-by.**
From simple drawings to elaborate displays, windows are becoming canvases for community spirit. It adds a lovely splash of colour and creativity to our streets.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of crisps will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: SMELLING THE PACKET BEFORE OPENING IT, HOPING FOR A HINT OF FLAVOUR!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot cup of tea, especially if it's a new blend. What is it?

ANSWER: GENTLY SWIRLING THE TEACUP THREE TIMES BEFORE TAKING THE FIRST SIP, 'TO ACTIVATE THE FLAVOUR'.

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those 'little rituals' we do on a weekday morning that just make the day feel like it's started right, don't we?**

Whether it's a specific order for your breakfast, a certain song you always play, or a quick check of the garden, what's that one small thing you do that just sets you up for a good day?

- **You know how sometimes a 'particular type of biscuit' just instantly puts you in a good mood, or brings back a happy memory?**

Is there a specific biscuit that, no matter what, always makes you smile? Perhaps it reminds you of childhood, or a special person, or just tastes like pure comfort? What's your ultimate happy biscuit?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** There is a 'space junk' problem, with over 100 million pieces of debris, including lost tools and old rocket parts, orbiting Earth.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts once accidentally left a fully baked Victoria sponge floating outside the International Space Station, which orbited for two days before disintegrating.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The world's largest known snowflake was 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick, observed in Montana in 1887.
- Oxford University is older than the Aztec Empire.
- The 'king' of a deck of cards is the only one without a moustache.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- The phrase 'once in a blue moon' refers to the rare occurrence of a second full moon within the same calendar month.

On this day

Day 254 of the year, 111 days left in 2026. Today Battle of Tendra Day (Russia); Christian feast days: Blessed Francesco Bonifacio; Christian feast days: Blessed Bonaventura Gran; Christian feast days: Deiniol. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1970 — Taraji P. Henson, American actress and singer
- 1945 — Leo Kottke, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1956 — Tony Gilroy, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1949 — Roger Uttley, English rugby player and coach
- 1930 — Cathryn Damon, American actress and dancer (died 1987)
- 1989 — Michael J. Willett, American actor and musician
- 1959 — John Hawkes, American actor
- 1965 — Moby, American singer-songwriter, musician, and DJ

THE DAY TODAY

- 2024 — Hurricane Francine impacts the Gulf of Mexico, as a Category 2 hurricane.
- 2024 — Soyuz MS-26 is launched to the International Space Station, setting a record of 19 people in orbit at the same time.
- 1973 — A coup in Chile, headed by General Augusto Pinochet, topples the democratically elected president Salvador Allende.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2024 — Hurricane Francine impacts the Gulf of Mexico, as a Category 2 hurricane.
- 1989 — Hungary announces that the East German refugees who had been housed in temporary camps were free to leave for West Germany.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1972 — The San Francisco Bay Area Rapid Transit system begins passenger service.
- 2024 — Soyuz MS-26 is launched to the International Space Station, setting a record of 19 people in orbit at the same time.

- 2008 — A major Channel Tunnel fire breaks out on a freight train, resulting in the closure of part of the tunnel for six months.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 255 of the year, 110 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Ailbe (Elvis, Eilfyw) of Emly; Christian feast day: Guy of Anderlecht; Christian feast day: The Most Holy Name of the Blessed Virgin Mary; Christian feast day: John Henry Hobart (Episcopal Church (USA)). Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1940 — Linda Gray, American model and actress
- 1966 — Darren E. Burrows, American actor
- 1970 — Nathan Larson, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1942 — Maria Muldaur, American folk and blues singer
- 1994 — Druski, American comedian and actor
- 1930 — Larry Austin, American composer and educator (died 2018)
- 1991 — Mike Towell, Scottish professional boxer (died 2016)
- 1970 — Will Chase, American actor, director, and singer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1980 — Florida Commuter Airlines Flight 65 crashes into the Atlantic Ocean off West End, Bahamas, killing 34 people.
- 1988 — Hurricane Gilbert devastates Jamaica; it turns towards Mexico's Yucatán Peninsula two days later, causing an estimated \$5 billion in damage.
- 2003 — Iraq War: In Fallujah, U.S. forces mistakenly shoot and kill eight Iraqi police officers.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1992 — Abimael Guzmán, leader of the Shining Path, is captured by Peruvian special forces; shortly thereafter the rest of Shining Path's leadership fell as well.
- 1991 — NASA launches Space Shuttle Discovery on STS-48 to deploy the Upper Atmosphere Research Satellite.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar